

# Project Description: Master's Thesis

**Working Title:** Corporate Visions of Artificial Intelligence in Higher Education: A Comparative Analysis of Strategic Narratives, Values, and Technologies.

## 1 Problem Statement

Artificial Intelligence (AI) companies are increasingly influencing the landscape of higher education through the deployment of products (e.g., Microsoft Copilot, Google Gemini), strategic collaborations, and policy influence. However, the underlying visions these companies hold—ranging from the automation of teaching to human-AI collaboration—remain varied and often opaque.

This study investigates how major AI companies (including Microsoft, OpenAI, Google, Meta, Anthropic, and Coursera) envision the role of AI in higher education. By exploring differences and similarities in their narratives and technologies, the project seeks to uncover the values, assumptions, and economic interests driving their educational agendas.

## Research Questions

1. How do major AI companies describe the role of AI in higher education?
2. What educational problems do they claim AI can solve?
3. What values (e.g., efficiency, accessibility, creativity, equity) underpin their narrative?

## 2 Outline (Disposition)

- **Introduction:** Motivation, problem area, and research questions.
- **Literature Review:** Current state of AI in HE and the role of "Big Tech."
- **Theoretical Framework:** Sociotechnical imaginaries and corporate narrative analysis.
- **Methodology:** Text mining, topic modeling, and knowledge graph construction.
- **Analysis:** Individual company profiles and a typology of AI visions.
- **Discussion:** Implications for learning design and institutional autonomy.
- **Conclusion:** Summary of findings and recommendations.

## 3 Theory and Literature

The project will draw on literature regarding the "platformization" of education. Theoretically, the study will utilize concepts related to *strategic narratives* and *institutional*

*autonomy* to understand how corporate visions may reshape educational practices.

## 4 Empirical Data

The empirical basis consists of publicly available documents from major AI companies.

- **Data Sources:** White papers, blog posts, and strategy papers.
- **Focus:** Specific focus on narratives surrounding tools like Microsoft Copilot and Google Gemini.

## 5 Methodological Reflections

The study employs a computational-qualitative hybrid approach:

- **Data Processing:** Text mining and topic modeling to identify recurring themes.
- **Visualization:** Use of knowledge graphs to map relationships between strategies and values.
- **Outcome:** A typology of AI visions and a comparative map.

## 6 Work Plan (Draft)

| Phase   | Activity                     | Completion      |
|---------|------------------------------|-----------------|
| Phase 1 | Literature review and theory | Month 1         |
| Phase 2 | Data collection (scraping)   | Month 1–2       |
| Phase 3 | Text mining & topic modeling | Month 2–3       |
| Phase 4 | Knowledge graph construction | Month 3–4       |
| Phase 5 | Drafting chapters            | Month 4–5       |
| Phase 6 | Final editing and submission | End of Semester |